either in the local army or in those of its Bengali rivals. The Muslim group now known as the Kamans arrived in the 1660s as mercenaries recruited from Afghanistan. After their military power was broken they adopted a local dialect and are now, unlike the Rohingyas, one of the accepted ethnic groups within Myanmar. However, it seems likely that the Rohingyas were an important part of the ethnic mix of Arakan in this era. Nineteenth-century British reports make reference to how the local Muslims called themselves 'Rovingaw' or 'Rooinga' (see Appendix 1, which reproduces the title page of one such work).[41] More importantly, as early as 1799 Francis Buchanan made reference to 'Rooinga' in the area.

Buchanan suggested in 1799 that the natives of Arakan were either 'Yakein' or 'Rooinga' and he indicates there are two main communities. One is the 'Mohammedans who have long settled in Arakan and who call themselves Rooinga, or natives of Arakan'.[42] The other are the 'Rakhing … who adhere to the tenets of Buddha'.[43] He also notes that due to fewer external interactions the Rakhing 'language is consequently purer than that of the Burmeses, who sustained several revolutions'.[44] This strongly suggests that after the arrival of the Rakhine in Arakan around 1000 AD the ethnic mix of the province remained static with relatively little interaction with the outside world. In turn, the *Classical Journal* of 1811 has a comparative list of numbers in many East and Central Asian languages and identifies three languages spoken in the 'Burmah Empire', including a direct reference to 'Rooinga':